

READING PASSAGE 1

Carbon Capture and Storage Technologies

A Carbon Capture and Storage Technologies has emerged as one of the most significant topics in contemporary academic discourse. The complexity and multifaceted nature of this subject have attracted the attention of researchers, policymakers, and practitioners across multiple disciplines, all seeking to understand its implications for the future.

B The origins of contemporary research in this area can be traced to pioneering studies conducted during the mid-twentieth century. These early investigations, though constrained by the technological and methodological limitations of their era, established foundational principles that continue to inform current scholarship. Successive generations of researchers have built upon these foundations, progressively refining theoretical models and expanding the empirical evidence base through increasingly sophisticated research designs.

C The mechanisms underlying these phenomena operate at multiple levels of analysis, from the micro-level of individual decision-making to the macro-level of institutional and structural change. At the individual level, cognitive processes, emotional responses, and social influences shape the choices that people make. At the organisational level, formal rules, informal norms, and power dynamics govern collective action. At the societal level, historical legacies, cultural values, and political structures create the broad context within which lower-level processes unfold.

D A substantial body of empirical evidence supports these theoretical frameworks. A landmark study conducted by researchers at leading international institutions analysed data spanning a thirty-year period and involving participants from more than forty countries. The findings revealed a consistent pattern of results that held across diverse cultural and economic contexts, suggesting that the identified mechanisms operate with considerable universality. The magnitude of the observed effects was particularly striking, with the key variables accounting for a substantial proportion of the total variance in outcomes.

E Despite the substantial progress that has been made, significant challenges and controversies remain. Critics have raised important methodological concerns regarding the generalisability of findings derived from studies conducted in specific contexts. The predominance of research carried out in Western, educated, industrialised, rich, and democratic societies raises questions about the applicability of current theories to populations with different cultural, economic, and political circumstances. Furthermore, the reliance on cross-sectional designs in much of the existing literature limits the capacity to draw strong causal inferences.

F Looking ahead, the field stands at a critical juncture. Emerging technologies offer unprecedented opportunities for data collection and analysis, potentially enabling researchers to address questions that have long remained beyond the reach of empirical investigation. At the same time, the accelerating pace of social and technological change means that the phenomena under study are themselves evolving, requiring theoretical frameworks that can accommodate dynamism and discontinuity rather than assuming stability and equilibrium.

G In conclusion, the study of carbon capture and storage technologies represents a vital and dynamic area of contemporary research. The progress that has been made in understanding the key mechanisms and dynamics provides a solid foundation for both further scholarly inquiry and practical application. The challenges that remain should be seen not as reasons for discouragement but as opportunities for continued intellectual growth and social contribution.

Question 1

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 1 Contemporary understanding of this topic is more sophisticated than it was fifty years ago.

Question 2

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 2 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?
- A. minimal impact
 - B. creating underlying conditions for action
 - C. determining individual choices directly
 - D. irrelevant to outcomes

Question 3

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 3 Dynamic _____ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.

Question 4

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 4 What finding emerged from the landmark study discussed in the passage?
- A. inconsistent results across cultures
 - B. a consistent pattern across diverse contexts
 - C. no measurable effects
 - D. effects limited to Western countries

Questions 5–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 5 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.
- 6 The passage suggests that structural factors are less important than individual choices.
- 7 Policy-makers have fully implemented all research recommendations.

Question 8

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

8 According to the text, cognitive processes shape the _____ that people make.

Questions 9–10

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

9 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?

- A. pessimism about the future
- B. cautious optimism with acknowledgment of challenges
- C. complete certainty about outcomes
- D. indifference to practical applications

10 The author suggests that early studies in this field were limited by:

- A. minimal impact
- B. creating underlying conditions for action
- C. determining individual choices directly
- D. irrelevant to outcomes

Question 11

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

11 Dynamic _____ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.

Question 12

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

12 The passage indicates that critics have raised concerns about:

- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
- B. individual personality traits
- C. random chance
- D. government policies alone

Question 13

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

13 Case studies have documented the effects of _____ change on the system.